

Brett Hicks

Art Director

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Summary

Art director with 16 years directing digital design for national brands including Tractor Supply Co., Ryman Hospitality Properties, Rite Aid, and Crunchyroll. Led design direction and front-end delivery across 250+ client websites, specializing in employer brand systems and recruitment platforms serving workforces of 50,000+. Rare design-to-code capability: I direct the work and ship it, so intent survives implementation. Experienced mentoring designers, presenting to enterprise stakeholders, and building systems that stay maintainable by non-designers long after launch.

Skills

Art Direction | Brand and Identity Systems | Design Systems | Information Architecture | Typography | Layout | UI/UX | Web Accessibility (WCAG AA) | Responsive Design | Adobe Creative Suite | Figma | Illustration

HTML5 | CSS3 | JavaScript | React | TypeScript | Next.js | TailwindCSS | Git | CI/CD | Agile Delivery | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Mentorship

Selected Work

Rite Aid Careers: employer brand system spanning 4 brands, 17 states, 2,400+ locations (2022 to 2024)

TSC Careers: recruitment platform scaled through 23% store growth to 2,000+ Tractor Supply stores (2017–2023)

TSC Benefits: internal benefits platform serving 54,000 team members, in continuous service 8+ years (2018 to present)

Ryman Careers: employer identity unifying 9 cultural brands across 6 markets (2018 to 2022)

TSC CMTK: A business application site that serves 2,300+ TSC stores to help them plan community events and sponsorships for County Fairs. Using this tool, stores sponsor 1,200+ County Fairs annually. The site also helped stores manage 20,000 to 30,000 event partners for local store events annually.

Experience

Art Director | Front-End Developer

Feb 2025 - Current

Brett Hicks Design | Nashville, TN

- Directed brand and web design for clients across music, retail, and professional services, handling engagements end to end from strategy and design through build and ongoing maintenance.
- Continued as design partner on Tractor Supply's internal benefits platform, delivering interface updates and digital assets supporting communication to 54,000+ team members.
- Restructured and redesigned the website for Sera Business Advisors, a business consulting and corporate training firm, reorganizing a multi-service offering into a clear information architecture and providing continued design support.
- Designed album artwork, iconography, and logo work for Nashville recording artist N. Justice across multiple releases, with covers appearing on projects that have accumulated 500,000+ combined streams.

Art Director | Front-End Developer

June 2015 - Feb 2025

Blue Tractor Digital Design Co. | Nashville, TN

- Directed design and front-end delivery for 250+ client websites, including national work for Tractor Supply Co., Ryman Hospitality Properties, Rite Aid, and Crunchyroll.
- Led art direction on enterprise recruitment and employer brand platforms serving workforces of up to 54,000 team members across 49 states, translating business hiring problems into information architecture, visual systems, and shipped interfaces.
- Mentored mid-level designers in visual craft and front-end best practices, improving code quality and team efficiency.
- Built and maintained design systems that outlasted their launches: one recruitment platform absorbed 25% company growth across six years without a redesign, and an internal benefits platform has run continuously for eight years and eight open enrollment cycles.
- Established brand architecture allowing multiple subsidiary brands to retain distinct identity while reading as a single employer, across portfolios of up to 9 consumer brands.

- Directed accessibility and performance standards as design constraints rather than post-production fixes, targeting WCAG AA and low-bandwidth mobile conditions from the first comp forward.
- Presented creative direction to enterprise stakeholders across HR, recruiting, and marketing, aligning competing internal audiences on a single approach.
- Managed concurrent delivery across multiple active client accounts, owning scope, timeline, and creative quality.
- Progressively modernized studio practice from static HTML and CSS through responsive design, component systems, and Git-based workflow, moving live client platforms forward without disruptive rebuilds.

Senior Web Designer | Front-End Developer

June 2013 - June 2015

Blue Tractor Digital Design Co. | Nashville, TN

- Adopted the use of Bootstrap Framework to increase efficiency and speed up development
- Mentored interns and junior designers on design and front-end development
- Illustrated character art and assets for numerous games for web and mobile platforms
- Designed and wrote the front-end for Tractor Supply Co Community Marketing Toolkit: A business application site that serves **2,300+ TSC stores** to help them plan community events and sponsorships for County Fairs. Using this tool, stores sponsor **1,200+ County Fairs annually**. The site also helped stores manage **20,000 to 30,000 event partners** for local store events annually.
- Designed digital and promotional material for Dumor Champion's Club such as site design and front-end, coupon design
- Redesigned, and maintained Nashville River Front site
- Managed multiple projects simultaneously, collaborating with my Creative Director to establish proper time frames and deadlines for various steps for each project. This ensured proper time management and was key to eliminating dead time waiting on client responses, and staying on track to meet every deadline.

Web Designer

May 2010 - Jun 2013

Blue Tractor Digital Design Co. | Nashville, TN

- Designed product and marketing sites, as well as web applications for clients such as: Monterey Boats, Red Kap, Tennessee Bank & Trust, Tractor Supply Co., and the City of Nashville just to name a few
- Designed the Logo and Branding of ContestApps **winning an AIGA Case award** .
- Designed and built the front end for the Walk100 for the city of Nashville, which **recorded over 6,000 users and logged over 105,000 miles walked by Nashvillians**. The initiative was covered by all of the major media outlets in the city. Not only was the program successful, it has been duplicated by other cities as well on top of **winning an AIGA Case Award**.
- Created animations through Adobe Flash, executing storyboard requirements and creating solutions to complex problems involving Action Script such as: Animated Games with AS logic, controlling animation timelines to turn a single video into an entire interactive presentation
- Designed and wrote code for Eblast campaign creation for TSC 4-H & FFA, Titan Management Group
- Collaborated with designers and copywriters of our design partner Locomotion Creative
- Illustrated characters and animation assets for Vampire Monkeys, an animation show.

Awards

Nashville AIGA Case Award Branding Design "ContestApps" - 2011

Nashville AIGA Case Award Site Design "Walk100" - 2011

Addy, Professional Gold "Porte Italia" website - 2018

Education

Middle Tennessee State University - BFA, Graphic Design / Web Design 2010

Codecademy - Professional Certificate, Front-End Engineer 2025

Codecademy - Professional Certificate, Full-Stack Engineer 2026